Dere Types: An Open Reference to Dere Character Archetypes for Fiction and AI Character Design

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Reference documentation / dataset companion

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The author founded ChatBrat. This PDF does not establish independent validation, peer review, benchmark scores, or product superiority. It is a readable companion to the cited archived README. The archived sources, data, methods, and publication dates remain authoritative for that version. Historical product claims are not a statement of current availability.

Current product scope: ChatBrat is browser-based character chat and roleplay, free during beta. A free account is needed for saved memory and creation. Saved conversation memory is selective, and carry-over into new chats requires opt-in. Explicit sexual content is prohibited. See the current memory documentation and pricing page. These links are product sources, not independent corroboration.

An open reference guide to Japanese-inspired dere character archetypes, their personality traits, behavioral patterns, and use in AI character design and roleplay.

What Is a Dere Type?

A dere type is a character archetype used to describe recurring patterns of personality, affection, social behavior, and emotional expression. The "dere" naming convention is commonly used for Japanese-inspired fictional characters, particularly characters whose outward behavior and relationships follow recognizable patterns.

The suffix *dere* comes from the Japanese ideophone *dere dere* (デレデレ), meaning lovey-dovey or infatuated. A dere type name pairs it with a word for the character's distinctive way of being: *tsun tsun* (aloof) gives **tsundere**, *kūru* (cool) gives **kuudere**, *hime* (princess) gives **himedere**, and so on. The terms began in Japanese anime, manga, game and visual novel fandom and are now widely used as shorthand for character personality in fiction, fan communities, character design and roleplay.

Dere types are not rigid psychological diagnoses or scientifically validated personality categories. They are fictional character archetypes used in storytelling, fandom, character design and roleplay. See Dere types are not psychological diagnoses.

Some terms, such as tsundere and yandere, are well documented. Others are newer, fan-coined and used less consistently. Each page states how certain the origin of its name is.

Core Dere Types

Type	Quick definition	Usage
Tsundere	Cold, irritable or dismissive toward someone they care about, while gradually or intermittently revealing warmth and affection.	core
Yandere	Intense affection that can become possessive or obsessive, in fiction sometimes escalating to extreme or dangerous behavior.	core
Kuudere	Calm, composed and emotionally reserved; affection is expressed in understated ways.	core
Dandere	Quiet and socially reserved, often shy; becomes more talkative and expressive with people they feel comfortable with.	core
Deredere	Openly warm, cheerful and affectionate, expressing care directly.	common
Himedere	Princess-like expectations, pride, authority, and a desire for admiration or special treatment.	common
Kamidere	God-like self-regard: superiority, a desire for authority, and an expectation of recognition.	common
Oujidere	Prince-like expectations: confidence, regal or chivalrous self-presentation, and expected respect.	niche
Sadodere	Expresses interest through teasing, provocation or playful control.	niche
Mayadere	Begins as an antagonist or rival and becomes an ally or love interest after a turning point.	niche
Bakadere	Naive, scatterbrained or clumsy; expresses affection with unfiltered enthusiasm.	niche

Usage is an editorial label: **core** terms are widely recognized and documented in reference works; **common** terms are widely used in fandom; **niche** terms are fan-coined and less consistently used.

Every page follows the same structure: definition, quick definition, meaning of the name, defining traits, typical behavior, relationship behavior, common misconceptions, use in AI character design, character consistency, and related types.

Dere Types at a Glance

Dere Type	Core Pattern	Typical Exterior	Relationship Pattern
Tsundere	Defensive affection	Cold, irritated, embarrassed	Affection emerges through conflict or vulnerability
Yandere	Intense attachment	Loving, intense, potentially possessive	Attachment can become obsessive
Kuudere	Emotional restraint	Calm, cool, reserved	Affection tends to be understated
Dandere	Shyness/reserve	Quiet, withdrawn	Opens up through comfort and trust
Deredere	Open affection	Cheerful, warm	Affection is expressed openly
Himedere	Royal/princess expectations	Proud, demanding	Expects admiration and special treatment
Oujidere	Prince-like expectations	Regal, confident	Expects respect and elevated treatment
Kamidere	God-like superiority	Dominant, self-important	Expects authority or submission
Sadodere	Pleasure in teasing/control	Playful, provocative, dominant	Affection may involve teasing or control
Mayadere	Formerly antagonistic	Hostile or dangerous initially	Relationship changes after a turning point
Bakadere	Naive/airheaded behavior	Energetic, silly, innocent	Affection expressed without much subtlety

These are concise reference descriptions, not universal definitions. Individual characters combine and bend archetypes.

Dere Types in AI Characters

A dere type is best understood as a **behavioral tendency**, not a script. A character labeled "tsundere" should not insult the user in every message, and a "himedere" should not announce she is a princess every turn.

- A tsundere should not be hostile in every interaction.

- A himedere should not constantly announce that she is a princess.

- A kuudere should not be emotionless.

- A dandere should not be incapable of speaking.

- A yandere should not automatically be violent.

- A deredere should not be cheerful regardless of context.

The archetype influences **how** the character responds. The current situation, the relationship, previous interactions and the character's development determine **what** the response is.

```
Dere Type
    +
Current Situation
    +
Relationship
    +
Previous Interactions
    ↓
Contextual Behavior
```

For example, a himedere's expectation of admiration matters when it is relevant: receiving praise may produce visible satisfaction; being ignored may produce irritation; being treated respectfully may reinforce trust; being publicly embarrassed may trigger defensiveness; becoming emotionally attached may gradually soften her behavior.

The goal is consistent behavioral expression, not repetitive output. A dere type is a starting point, not a complete character specification. See Dere Types in AI Character Design for how to turn a label into a usable character definition, including a full example.

Character Consistency vs. Repetition

> **Character consistency ≠ character repetition.**

Character consistency means that a character's behavior remains compatible with their established personality, circumstances, relationships and development. A consistent character can behave differently from one conversation to the next and still be recognizable. A character who says the same catchphrases in every message is repetitive, not well realized.

The key question is: **does the character's behavior still make sense given everything that has happened?** See Character Consistency.

Dere Types and Character Development

Characters change. The important question is why.

> **Character development has a cause; character drift often doesn't.**

A himedere who gradually becomes more vulnerable with someone she trusts is developing. A himedere who suddenly loses all pride for no reason has drifted. This distinction matters most in long-running AI roleplay, where characters may change over hundreds of conversations. See Character Development vs. Character Drift.

Dere Types and AI Memory

Dere types describe how a character tends to behave. Memory determines how previous interactions can influence how that character behaves later.

These are separate dimensions, so an AI character can have:

1. strong character consistency but poor memory;

2. strong memory but poor character consistency;

3. both;

4. neither.

A character may correctly remember the user's favorite book while responding in a way that is completely out of character. Another may be a convincing himedere in every message while forgetting what happened yesterday.

Question	Dimension
Does the character continue to behave like the character it was designed to be?	**Character consistency**
Do previous interactions meaningfully influence later conversations and behavior?	**Memory continuity**

```
Character Archetype
        +
Character Traits
        +
Relationship History
        +
Relevant Memory
        +
Current Context
        ↓
Character Response
```

This is one reason long-running AI roleplay is more complex than giving an AI a personality prompt. Memory continuity is measured by the companion project, the AI Character Memory Benchmark. Neither repository depends on the other.

```
AI Character
     │
     ├── Personality / Archetype  →  Dere Types (this repository)
     │
     └── Memory / Continuity      →  AI Character Memory Benchmark
```

Dere Types Are Not Psychological Diagnoses

Dere types are fictional character archetypes and fandom terminology, not clinically validated psychological categories or personality diagnoses.

- A dere type does not diagnose anyone's personality.

- A dere type does not predict real-world behavior.

- A dere type is not equivalent to any clinical condition.

- Fictional archetypes do not map onto psychological disorders. Words like "sick" in *yandere* or "sadist" in *sadodere* are fictional framing, not clinical terms.

This repository is about fictional character design.

Machine-Readable Data

Each type has a YAML file in `data/` that follows `schema/dere-type.schema.json` (JSON Schema draft 2020-12). The data is intended for developers, AI character creators, researchers, dataset builders, character-card authors and roleplay systems.

```
name: Himedere
category: dere-type
definition: >-
  A character archetype characterized by princess-like expectations, pride,
  authority, and a desire for admiration or special treatment, who may reveal
  a softer side toward people they trust.
core_traits: [pride, authority, high standards, desire for admiration, ...]
behavioral_patterns: [expects respect and courtesy, ...]
relationship_patterns: [values sincere admiration and loyalty, ...]
related_types: [oujidere, kamidere, tsundere]
common_misconceptions: ["A himedere is simply a dominant character.", ...]
term_origin: { components: [...], confidence: commonly-cited }
usage: common
```

Required fields: `name`, `category`, `definition`, `core_traits`, `behavioral_patterns`, `relationship_patterns`, `related_types`, `common_misconceptions`. Optional: `japanese`, `term_origin` (with a `confidence` of `established`, `commonly-cited` or `uncertain`), and `usage`.

Validate locally:

```
pip install pyyaml jsonschema
python tools/validate.py
```

The validator checks every file against the schema, checks that related types exist, and checks that each YAML definition matches the Quick Definition on its page.

Repository Structure

```
dere-types/
├── README.md
├── types/            one canonical page per dere type
├── data/             machine-readable YAML for each type
├── schema/           JSON Schema for the data
├── docs/
│   ├── dere-types-in-ai-character-design.md
│   ├── character-consistency.md
│   ├── character-development-vs-drift.md
│   └── references.md
├── tools/validate.py
├── CONTRIBUTING.md
├── CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md
├── CITATION.cff
├── CHANGELOG.md
└── LICENSE
```

Contributing

Corrections, better definitions, references, data improvements and proposals for additional types are welcome. Please distinguish established terminology from fandom usage and from your own interpretation. See CONTRIBUTING.md.

References

Terminology sources, Japanese language references, AI character research and clearly labeled background essays are listed in docs/references.md.

Maintainer

Maintained by Garret E. Williams (@garretewilliams). This repository is maintained by ChatBrat as an open reference for AI character design, roleplay, and conversational character systems. The taxonomy is intended to be useful across platforms and implementations. ChatBrat did not invent these terms and does not claim authority over Japanese language or culture.

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